

greatest companies today, I doubt that you'd put either one of them on it.

I can remember when the best stock was Control Data and when the best stock was Burroughs. In the 1950s utilities were considered growth stocks. A hundred years ago, as noted earlier, the best stock, hands down, was the Pennsylvania Railroad. Growth doesn't continue forever.

Or, as I seem to have heard somewhere, trees don't grow to the sky.

A hundred years ago, the best stock was the Pennsylvania Railroad.

Why Don't Trees Grow to the Sky?

That is the sort of nasty question a four-year-old might ask, for it is simple in form but takes some knowledge of science to answer. Luckily, there is a fine resource to consult on the question of why animals and plants have the size and shape that they do. The science classic *On Growth and Form*, by D'Arcy Thompson, is still in print despite its original publication date of nearly eighty years ago. And because it was written in England in 1917, it offers clear English prose instead of matrix algebra.

So, how high can a tree grow? The limit to the height of a tree is governed by its collapse under the force of gravity in a "column failure." The great mathematicians